

Chapter-4

Letter Writing

The world has become a global village with breathtaking advancements in communication and information technology. It takes only a fraction of second to convey a message to or share information with a person sitting in some other part of the world. People use phone calls, video-chat, text messages, e-mail and fax to share information. However, the importance of letters cannot be undermined. As a matter of fact, letters are the best means to communicate one's innermost feelings and thoughts in an elaborate and effective way. Majorly, letters may be classified in two categories:

1. **Informal Letters:** Letters written to members of family, friends and relatives
2. **Formal Letters:** Applications, Letters to editor, Letters to businessmen, firms, publishers, government authorities, private offices etc.

Informal Letters

Informal letters, also known as personal letters, are the letters written to members of family, friends, or relatives. Although called informal letters, they are written in formal English as far as possible with a few exceptions or expressions here and there. There is no specified word limit for an informal letter; however it should contain only the relevant information and justify the purpose of writing the letter. The content should be well organised and presented in an effective way using appropriate cohesive devices.

Purpose of Informal Letters

- ✓ To share joys and sorrows
- ✓ To write invitations for different purposes
- ✓ To reply to invitations
- ✓ To express feelings
- ✓ To narrate different experiences
- ✓ To make proposals/suggestions/advice
- ✓ To send reminders
- ✓ To announce a birth, death, result, achievement etc.
- ✓ To congratulate on some occasion
- ✓ To express gratitude
- ✓ To write letters of apology or condolence

Constituents of an Informal Letter

1. **Sender's Address:** It is written at the top left corner of the letter. It includes:
 - House/flat/shop/ number
 - Name of building in case of flat
 - Name/number of street
 - Name of sector/colony, one can also include a landmark such as opposite SBI Branch or Near Orbit Mall etc.
 - Name of village/town/city
 - Pin code
 - State
 - Country (if the letter is written to a person staying in some other country)
2. **Date:** It is written below the sender's address. There are many formats of writing a date. The name of the month should be written complete. Study carefully the formats of date given below.
 - D/M/Y: 24th November, 20XX or 24 November, 20XX
 - M/D/Y: November 24, 20XX

3. **Salutation:** Salutation is the way we address the recipient of the letter. It is written below the date. Read the examples of salutation given below.

- **For members of family or relatives:**

- ✓ Dear(est) Papa/Pa/Father/Dad/Daddy
- ✓ Dear(est) Mother/Mom/Ma
- ✓ Dear(est) Uncle/Aunt/Auntie
- ✓ Dear(est) Brother/Sister

- **For friends:**

- ✓ Dear(est) Rahul/Ritika (Avoid writing Dear Friend or Dear Friend Arunima)

4. **Body of the letter:** It is the main part of the letter which contains the message or the information meant to be conveyed through the letter. Although there is no hard and fast rule regarding the number of paragraphs it should contain, it is usually written in three or four paragraphs depending on the content to be written.

The body has three parts:

(a) **Introduction:** The first paragraph is the introduction where the writer can use expressions such as:

- How are you? How are you doing? Hope you are doing well.
- I hope this letter finds you in high spirits.
- I received your letter last..... or on.....
- I am sorry for replying late to your letter as.....
- I am writing this letter to.....
- I am extremely delighted/ happy/ excited to inform you.....
- I am extremely happy to know about.....
- I am deeply saddened/heartbroken/shocked to know about the sudden demise /accident of your.....
- You will be glad to know that.....
- I am thankful to for.....

(b) **Main Message:** The second paragraph is the main message or information to be conveyed. This part should be well organised using appropriate cohesive devices.

(c) **Closure:** The third paragraph concludes the letter. It usually contains leave taking, conveying regards to others, inviting the reader or making a commitment. One may ask the reader to respond for something. One may add complimentary closures such as “With lots of love”, “Waiting for you” or “Hope to see you soon” etc.

5. **Subscription:** It is a polite way of closing the letter or signing off. Read the examples of Subscription given below.

- **For members of family or relatives:**

- ✓ Yours affectionately/lovingly

- **For friends:**

- ✓ Yours sincerely

6. **Signature:** The sender's signature is written just below the subscription

Format of an Informal Letter

Sender's Address

Date of writing the letter

Salutation

Introduction

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Main message

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Closure

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Complimentary closure

Subscription
Signature

Informal Letter Sample

Write a letter to your friend inviting him/her to spend his/her winter break with you.

House No. 45, Street No. 2
New Azad Nagar
Ludhiana

December 2, 20XX

Dear Abhijeet

How are you? I received your letter in which you have written about your preparation for the Third Unit Examination to be commenced from December 9. I am very happy and satisfied to know that you have prepared well for your examination. I wish you all the luck for the same.

Your winter vacation will start from 25th December and last up to 5th January. It will be wonderful if you spend your winter break with me at Ludhiana. It will be a great opportunity for us to spend time together. I have already talked to my parents and friends about it. My parents will be extremely delighted to host you. My mother will prepare us delicious dishes. My friends are eagerly waiting for you.

I have chalked out the schedule for your stay. First of all we will have a get together of all my friends at my place. We will visit some of the best shopping malls of Ludhiana. We will also watch some of the latest movies. We will play video games together. I have also planned a two day trip to Chandigarh. We will visit the famous places at Chandigarh such as Rose Garden, Rock Garden, Sukhna Lake and Chhat Beer, the zoo. We will spend an evening at Sector-17 and enjoy the musical fountain show there. We will make the best use of our stay together.

I hope you won't disappoint me and plan your stay at my place as soon as possible. Convey my best regards to your parents and love to little Surabhi. I will wait eagerly for you.

With lots of love

Yours sincerely
Anuraag

1. Suppose you are Poorvi, a resident of B37, Sector 28 A, Panchkula. Write a letter to your grandfather thanking him for the birthday gift he has sent you.



Hints: Thanks giving, name of gift, brand, material, utility and importance, promise to keep it safe, thank again.

This image shows a full page of white paper with horizontal dotted lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page, providing a guide for handwriting practice. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the page.

2. Suppose you are Vikas Munjal, a resident of 67/49, Swarn Path, Mansarovar, Jaipur. Write a letter to your friend congratulating him on his grand success in final examination.



Hints: Congratulate, give credits, demand a treat, best wishes for future endeavour

This image shows a full page of a document template designed for handwritten notes or essays. It features approximately 28 evenly spaced, thin grey horizontal lines across the entire width of the page. The margins are consistent on all sides, providing ample space for writing. There are no pre-printed questions, headings, or other markings on the page.

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4. Suppose you are Navjot Singh living at H. No. 165, Gandhi Nagar, Hoshiarpur. Write a letter to your uncle telling him about your new school.

[illegible]

5. Suppose you are Vaibhav Narula, living at Flat No. 56, Gokuldharm Society, Delhi. Write a letter of condolence to your friend who has recently lost his mother



Hints: Deeply saddened, sudden and untimely demise, deep condolence, pious soul, lady of virtue, treated everyone well, departed soul, rest in peace, God grant strength to the bereaved family to bear the loss, face bravely, take care of yourself and family

[illegible]

[illegible]